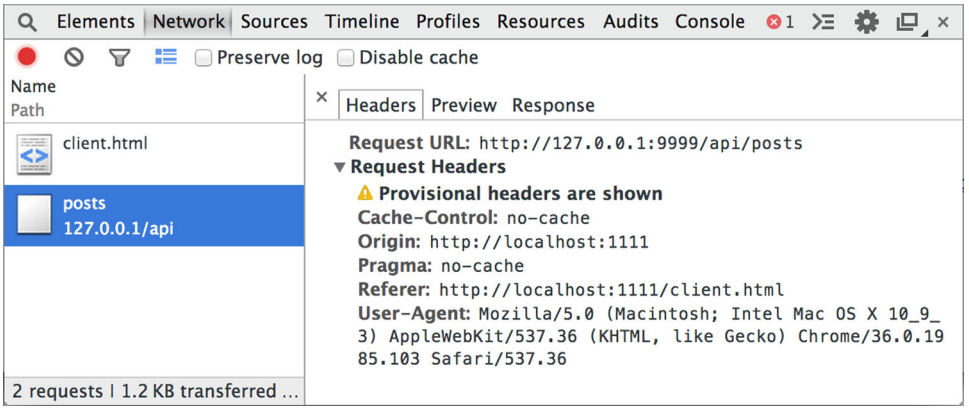


Figure 3.14 The Origin header on the HTTP request

3.4.2 What is an origin?

The origin defines where the client resource lives. The origin for the page at http://localhost:1111/client.html is http://localhost:1111. In other words, the origin is everything in the URL up until the path. In more formal terms, the origin is the scheme, host, and port of a URL, as shown in figure 3.15.

Table 3.2 shows the origins for various URLs (note that these are example URLs, and some won't actually work in your browser).

Table 3.2 Origin values for various example URLs

URL	Origin
http://localhost:1111	http://localhost:1111
http://localhost:1111/client.html	http://localhost:1111
https://localhost:1111/client.html	https://localhost:1111
http://localhost/client.html	http://localhost
file:///Users/hossain/ch02/client.html	`null`

The string `null` can also be a valid value for the origin, even though it doesn't follow the scheme/host/port pattern. Browsers use the value `null` when the origin of the client can't be determined. An example of this is opening a file in your browser. The file

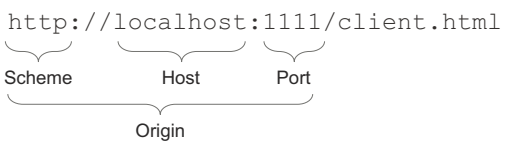


Figure 3.15 The origin consists of the scheme, host, and port.